FOUNDER FRAMEWORK #002 · SATURDAY

Zerodha. India's largest broker, built with ₹0 funding and ₹0 ads.

Series · Founder Framework (Sat) **Date** · 01 Aug 2026 **Subject** · Zerodha / Nithin Kamath

Framework · Price → product → profit

01 Carousel caption (posts 08:00 IST)

How do you build India's largest stock broker with no funding and no advertising?

Zerodha did exactly that. Nithin and Nikhil Kamath started it in 2010, never raised a rupee of outside capital, never ran a single ad, and still out-earned brokers ten times their age. Here's the framework they used.

Step one: break the market open on price. Every broker charged a percentage of your trade, so a big trade could cost you over a thousand rupees. Zerodha charged a flat ₹20, and made equity delivery free. The same trade that cost ₹1,000 elsewhere now cost ₹20. The old pricing model simply broke.

Step two: make the product the marketing. Instead of buying attention, Zerodha earned it. It taught a generation to invest with free education through Varsity, and answered questions in the open. Happy users did the selling. A product people can't stop recommending is cheaper than any ad, and it compounds.

Step three: stay profitable, stay free. By FY24 Zerodha did around ₹9,993 crore in revenue and ₹5,496 crore in profit, funded by nobody. No burn, no raise, no one to answer to.

Now the honest part, because this isn't a fairy tale. New SEBI rules on F&O cooled trading, and Groww caught up on new clients. FY25 profit fell about 23%. Even a great model rides the cycle it sits in. But because Zerodha took no money, it can absorb a down year on its own terms.

The framework for founders: price to break the market open, let the product be the ad, and stay profitable so nobody else steers the ship.

💬 Would you build without ever raising?
❤️ Save this if you're building for the long game.

📚 Sources: Business Standard, The Clueless Company, company filings
⚠️ Editorial analysis of publicly available information. Not investment advice.

#startup #founders #bootstrapped #zerodha #startupindia

SEO Keywords (one line, comma-separated, for captions, alt text, cross-posting, YouTube/blog)

zerodha, nithin kamath, zerodha founder framework, bootstrapped startup india, how zerodha grew, zerodha no funding, zerodha business model, discount broking india, flat fee broking, build without funding, product led growth india, zero marketing spend, profitable startup india, zerodha revenue profit, nikhil kamath, indian fintech startup, founder lessons india, bootstrapping vs venture capital, startupsutra founder framework, build a startup without raising money

02 Reel caption (evening · single reel, reversal hook)

REEL · REVERSAL HOOK

Everyone thinks you need funding and ads to win. Zerodha built India's largest broker with neither.

Nithin Kamath started it in 2010, raised ₹0 from outside, spent ₹0 on advertising, and still out-earned brokers ten times its age.

The framework: break the market open on price (flat ₹20 a trade), let the product be the marketing (free education, word of mouth), and stay profitable so nobody else steers the ship. FY24: about ₹9,993 crore revenue, ₹5,496 crore profit, funded by nobody.

💬 Would you build without ever raising?
📚 Sources: Business Standard, company filings. ⚠️ Not investment advice.

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03 Alt text 7 slides

1. **1.** Founder Framework, Zerodha. It never raised a rupee, never ran a single ad, and still became India's largest broker.
2. **2.** Snapshot: Zerodha, founded 2010 in Bengaluru by Nithin and Nikhil Kamath, zero outside funding, a discount stock broker charging a flat ₹20 a trade. The name is "zero" plus "rodha", Sanskrit for barrier.
3. **3.** Step one, break the market open on price: old brokers charged a percentage, up to ₹1,000-plus a trade; Zerodha charged a flat ₹20 and made equity delivery free, breaking the old pricing model.
4. **4.** Step two, make the product the marketing: Zerodha spent nothing on ads, teaching India to invest through free education and answering questions in the open, so users became the marketing.
5. **5.** Step three, stay profitable and free: FY24 revenue around ₹9,993 crore, profit ₹5,496 crore at roughly 55 percent margin, over 1.6 crore clients, and zero investors.
6. **6.** The honest part: new SEBI F&O rules cooled trading and Groww caught up on new clients, FY25 profit fell about 23 percent, but with no outside money Zerodha can absorb a down year on its own terms.
7. **7.** The framework: break the market on price, let the product be the ad, and stay profitable so no one steers you. Follow @statupsutra, Founder Framework on Saturdays.

04 Hashtags, Stories & timing

CORE

#startup #founders #bootstrapped #zerodha #startupindia

EXTENDED

#nithinkamath #fintech #entrepreneurship #productledgrowth #buildinpublic #founderjourney #india #stockmarket #investing

Stories: teaser "he built India's biggest broker with ₹0 funding and ₹0 ads. Guess how 👀" → follow-up "Could you build without ever raising? Yes/No" → BTS "zero + rodha = no barrier". Tag **@zerodhaonline** in first comment.

LOCKED SCHEDULE (IST)

TIME	ASSET
08:00	**Carousel**, slides 1 to 7
~18:00	**Story** teaser
20:00	**Reel** (reversal hook)
20:05	**Story** follow-up

One reel only. Reply to every comment within the hour.